# Curriculum Vitæ - Vinicius Moris Placco

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## Personal information


| | |
|---|---|
| Full name | Vinicius [v-knee-see-uh-s] Moris Placco |
| Languages | Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), Italian (basic) |
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## Employment / Appointments

| | |
|---|---|
| 2024– | US National Gemini Office Head – Community Science & Data Center<br>U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory |
| 2022– | Associate Astronomer – Community Science & Data Center<br>U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory |
| 2023–2024 | US National Gemini Office Acting Head – Community Science & Data Center<br>U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory |
| 2020–2022 | Associate Scientist – Community Science & Data Center<br>U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory |
| 2015–2020 | Research Assistant Professor – Department of Physics<br>University of Notre Dame |
| 2018–2020 | Faculty Fellow – Liu Institute for Asia and Asian Studies<br>University of Notre Dame |
| 2014–2015 | Science Fellow<br>Gemini Observatory – Northern Operations Center<br>Association of Universities for Research in Astronomy |
| 2013–2014 | Postdoctoral Fellow<br>National Optical Astronomy Observatory<br>Association of Universities for Research in Astronomy |
| 2010–2013 | Postdoctoral Fellow<br>Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas<br>Universidade de São Paulo |
| 2010–2011 | External Consultant - Data Science and Statistics<br>Suzuki Veículos do Brasil S/A |
| 2010–2010 | Freelance Translator - Astronomy Brasil Magazine<br>Ediouro Duetto Editorial |

## Education

2007–2010 Doctorate degree in Astronomy
*Search for very metal-poor stars based on carbon over-abundance*
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo

2005–2007 Master's degree in Astronomy
*Abundance patterns among very metal-poor stars in the Galaxy: a statistical approach*
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo

2001–2005 Bachelor's degree in Physics (concentration: Astronomy)
Instituto de Física
Universidade de São Paulo

## Awards

2024 *Outstanding Achievement Award – Science*
U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory
Association of Universities for Research in Astronomy

2011 *Featured Astronomy thesis of the year 2010*
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo

2005 *Best Astronomy undergraduate project*
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo

# Observatory Experience

## Leardership roles/Service

2025–present US Member of the SOAR Telescope Board
2018–present Member of the J-PAS Survey Science Committee (Javalambre Physics of the Accelerating Universe Survey)
2018–present Co-coordinator of the Resolved Stellar Population Working Group of the J-PAS Survey
2017–present Member of the S-PLUS Advisory Committee (Southern Photometric Local Universe Survey)
2017–present Principal Investigator of the S-PLUS Short Survey

2017–2023 Subaru Telescope Proposal reviewer – category group: Normal Stars, Metal-Poor Stars
2018–2024 Member of the Maunakea Spectroscopic Explorer (MSE) Science Team
2020–2023 Hubble Space Telescope External Proposal reviewer
2019–2020 Member of the NSF NOIRLab Time Allocation Committee - Galactic Panel 2
2017–2020 US representative for the Gemini Observatory Users Committee
2018–2019 Member of the NOAO Time Allocation Committee - Galactic Panel 2
2017–2018 Member of the Gemini OCS Upgrades Working Group
2018 US Extremely Large Telescope Program – First Stars Key Science Project

## Operations and Instrument/User Support

2020–present **NSF NOIRLab**: Community Science & Data Center – US National Gemini Office
Product development for the Gemini user community:
Twitter account bots – daily completion, weekly paper, monthly completion, other metrics
GitHub repositories – DRAGONS Imaging tutorials, IRAF Spectroscopy tutorials, users dashboard
Co-organization of AAS Splinter Meetings
Responsible for managing the NOIRLab IRAF modernization project
Migration and maintenance of the US NGO Portal
Migration and maintenance of the GMOS Cookbook
Migration and maintenance of the XDGNIRS Pipeline
Gemini HelpDesk – Responsible for selected Tiers 2 and 3 inquiries

2021–present **NSF NOIRLab**: Communications, Education & Engagement
Supported the migration of the NOAO Science website to the new NOIRLab Science website
Developed, revised, and curated content for the NOIRLab Science website
Serve as a liaison between RSS and CEE
Support science staff in adding/editing content on the science webpages
Responding/routing science inquiries from usercomms@noirlab.edu and info@noirlab.edu
Responsible for the curation of the NOIRLab Capabilities Brochure

2021–2022 **NSF NOIRLab**: Gemini Observatory – Science User Support Department
Part of the Science Verification effort for the DRAGONS spectroscopic routines
Early testing of the quick-look and interactive tools for DRAGONS
Performance comparison between Gemini/IRAF and DRAGONS packages

2014–2015 **Gemini-North**: Operations
Support Scientist for Phase II programs
Backup support for instrument teams
Interface between observatory and visitors (staff, scientists, and others)
Interactions with astronomers, engineers, IT personnel, and facilities staff
Community support (help-desk and troubleshooting)
Write/edit/update internal and external webpages
Weekly operations meetings
Queue observer
Data reductions

2014–2015 **Gemini-North**: GMOS Instrument Team
Instrument performance monitoring pipeline
Throughput characterization
Commissioning of AO capabilities
Write/edit/update internal and external instrument webpages
Data quality assessment
Commissioning of Hamamatsu CCD at GMOS-S

2014–2015 **Gemini-North**: GRACES Instrument Team
Commissioning of the instrument
Developed early data-reduction pipeline
Write/edit/update internal and external instrument webpages
Developed exposure time calculator (GRACES ITC v0.1 Beta)

2008–2012 **SOAR Telescope**: remote observing station – University of São Paulo
Responsible for operations and maintenance
Develop data reduction tools
Edit/write manuals and data analysis cookbooks
User support and troubleshooting
Configure, quote, and purchase new workstations and teleconference hardware
Work with staff and IT personel to ensure access to buildings and computers
Support daytime calibrations / nighttime observations

## Observing Experience

| Period | Telescope | # of nights | instrument | mode |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2019–present | CTIO/Blanco | 16 | COSMOS | remote |
| 2011–present | ESO/NTT | 12 | EFOSC2 | visitor |
| 2008–present | SOAR | 40+ | Goodman<br>OSIRIS | remote |
| 2013–2018 | KPNO/Mayall | 20+ | RCSPEC<br>KOSMOS | visitor/remote |
| 2014–2015 | Gemini North | 12 | GMOS<br>GRACES<br>GNIRS<br>NIRI<br>NIFS | queue observer |
| 2014–2015 | Gemini South | 2 | GMOS | remote |
| 2013 | McDonald 2.1m | 4 | ES2 Spectrometer | visitor |

# Research Experience

## Funding

### Current

2023–2027 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-I)
*Fission of Transuranic Nuclei: A Potential Observational Signature in Metal-Poor Stars*
Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 2,873)

### Past (Total: USD 475,229)

2025 International Research Network for Nuclear Astrophysics
*The 2nd IReNA-Ukakuren Joint Workshop Advancing Nuclear Astrophysics and Beyond*
(USD 5,000 - Travel support for conference)

2020–2022 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-I)
*Testing r-process nucleosynthesis models with two r-process enhanced stars*
Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 35,000)

2019–2021 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-PI)
*HD 222925: A unique opportunity to study the full range of nuclei produced by a single r-process event*
Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 60,732)

2018–2020 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-PI)
*The Unexplored Domains of the s-Process*
Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 119,104)

2018 Liu Institute for Asia & Asian Studies (PI)
*Stellar Archaeology as a Time Machine to the First Stars*
University of Notre Dame (USD 600 - Travel support for conference)

2018 Liu Institute for Asia & Asian Studies (PI)
*TDLI Workshop on The Exploding Universe*
University of Notre Dame (USD 2,600 - Travel support for conference)

2015–2017 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-I)
*The First Detections of Phosphorus, Sulphur, and Zinc in a Bona-Fide Second-Generation Star*
Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 85,293)

2016–2017 Faculty Research Support Program Initiation Grant (PI)
*Identification of CEMP Stars from S-PLUS Photometry using Artificial Neural Networks*
University of Notre Dame (USD 10,000)

2013–2014 FAPESP (State of São Paulo Research Foundation) – Postdoctorate
*(re)discovery and analysis of metal-poor stars in the Milky Way*
National Optical Astronomy Observatory (USD 71,400)

2010–2013 FAPESP (State of São Paulo Research Foundation) – Postdoctorate
*The Milky Way Halo revisited*
Universidade de São Paulo (USD 85,500)

## Fellowships

2007–2010 Doctorate – FAPESP (07/04356-3) – Universidade de São Paulo
*Search for very metal-poor stars based on carbon over-abundance*

2005–2007 Master's – FAPESP (05/01023-8) – Universidade de São Paulo
*Abundance patterns among very metal-poor stars in the Galaxy: a statistical approach*

2004–2005 Undergraduate research project – CNPq/PIBIC – Universidade de São Paulo
*Descoberta e Análise de Objetos com Linhas em Emissão no Survey HK*

2002–2004 Undergraduate research project – FAPESP (02/04704-8) – Universidade de São Paulo
*Construção de câmara de alvo gasoso para produção de feixes radioativos*

## Visiting Faculty/Postdoc/Graduate Student

2026 Stockholm University
Department of Astronomy
Funding: NOIRLab, Stickholm University (Sweden)

2026/2023 Universidade de São Paulo
2022 Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Funding: NOIRLab, USP/FAPESP (Brazil)

2020/2018 Universidade de São Paulo
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Funding: USP/FAPESP (Brazil), JINA-CEE

2018 Chungnam National University
Department of Astronomy & Space Science
Funding: CNU (Republic of Korea)

2014 University of Notre Dame
Department of Physics
Funding: Gemini Observatory and JINA (Joint Institute for Nuclear Asthophysics)

2014/2012 Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Kavli Institute for Astrophysics and Space Research
Funding: Gemini Observatory, FAPESP (The State of São Paulo Research Foundation – Brazil)

2013/2012 National Optical Astronomy Observatory
Kitt Peak National Observatory
Funding: FAPESP (Brazil)

2013 New Mexico State University
Department of Astronomy
Funding: FAPESP (Brazil)

2010/2008 Universität Heidelberg
Zentrum für Astronomie
Funding: Universität Heidelberg (Germany), FAPESP, PROEX (Brazil)

2010/2009 Michigan State University
2007 Physics and Astronomy Department
Funding: JINA (USA), FAPESP, PROEX (Brazil)

## Telescope time allocations

### Approved observing projects: 234
### Total awarded: 8029.19 hours

*does not include time allocated through university partnerships

**Principal Investigator: 61**
**Total awarded: 1832.47 hours**

**Co Investigator: 173**
**Total awarded: 6196.72 hours**

| Telescope | Proposals |
|---|---|
| GeminiSouth | 97 |
| GeminiNorth | 41 |
| SOAR | 34 |
| ESO/NTT | 10 |
| CTIO/Blanco | 9 |
| LCO/Magellan | 6 |
| SALT | 5 |
| KPNO/Mayall | 5 |
| McD/2.7m | 4 |
| ESO/VLT | 4 |
| NOT | 3 |
| LCO/duPont | 3 |
| McD/2.1m | 2 |
| LNA | 2 |
| HST | 2 |
| CFHT | 2 |
| APO | 2 |
| AAO/AAT | 2 |
| Subaru | 1 |

# Invited / Contributed Presentations

## 2026

**113**. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
*Why you should care about rainbows* (AI-generated version)

**112**. Escola Estadual Dom Pedro de Alcântara, Paraty
*A Tabela Periódica Astrofísica*

**111**. S-PLUS 21st Collaboration Meeting
*Why do we keep finding interesting stars with S-PLUS?*

**110**. Uppsala University – Astronomy and Space Physics Seminar
Stellar Genealogy: The Search for the First Stars and Everything in Between

**109**. Stockholm University – Astronomy Seminar
Stellar Genealogy: The Search for the First Stars and Everything in Between

**108**. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
*The Study of Rainbows*

**107**. Universidade de São Paulo – Astronomy Department Research Update
*HE 0144-4657: Finding what you are not looking for*

## 2025

**106**. Origin of Elements and Cosmic Evolution – Workshop
*Neutron-capture in the wild: Finding R-Process Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars in the Milky Way*

**105**. Origin of Elements and Cosmic Evolution – Pre-Workshop School
*Stellar Genealogy: Metal-Poor Stars as Probes of the Chemical Evolution of the Universe*

**104**. Kartchner Caverns State Park – Discovery Center Science Talk
*A tale of two stars: Revealing the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe*

**103**. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Kitt Peak Visitor Center Docent Meeting
*Astronomer by Accident: How Serendipity and Diligence Can Shape a Career*

**102**. S-PLUS Collaboration – Bi-weekly Science Seminar Series
*The DECam MAGIC Survey: Spectroscopic Follow-up of the Most Metal-poor Stars in the Distant Milky Way Halo – Going on an Informed Fishing Expedition*

**101**. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
*Spectroscopy for people in a hurry*

**100**. The 2nd IReNA-Ukakuren Joint Workshop "Advancing Nuclear Astrophysics and Beyond"
*Neutron-capture in the wild: finding r-process enhanced metal-poor stars in the Milky Way*

99. AAS 246 - Stars, Cool Dwarfs, Brown Dwarfs Session
*Finding Extremely and Ultra Metal-Poor Stars using Narrowband Photometry from the MAGIC Survey*

**98**. Kavli Institute for Cosmological Physics | The University of Chicago - Open Group Seminars
*BD+44°493: Where Near Field Cosmology Meets Exoplanet Science*

**97**. WIYN Board Meeting – Lunch Science Presentation
*BD+44°493: Chemo-Dynamics and Constraints on Companion Planetary Masses from WIYN/NEID Spectroscopy*

**96**. Huachuca Astronomy Club – Monthly Science Presentation
*A tale of two stars: Revealing the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe*

**95**. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
*Spectroscopy (a.k.a. the study of rainbows)*

**94**. AAS 245 - A conversation about the Gemini Observatory Strategic Plan for the 2030s
*GHOST Reduced Data Products for the Gemini Observatory Community and Beyond*

**93**. National Astronomical Observatory of Japan - Science Colloquium
*Stellar Genealogy: Rare Gems in the Milky Way as Probes of the Chemical Evolution of the Universe*

## 2024

**92**. NSF NOIRLab – Users Committee for NOIRLab (UCN)
*Aspects of Data Reduction Support at NOIRLab*

**91**. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
*Spectroscopy for People in a Hurry*

90. Nuclear Physics in Astrophysics XI
*Neutron-capture in the wild: finding r-process enhanced metal-poor stars in the Milky Way and beyond*

**89**. Rare Gems in Big Data
*Stellar Genealogy: Rare Gems in the Milky Way as Probes of the Chemical Evolution of the Universe*

**88**. Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
*Spectroscopy (a.k.a. the study of rainbows)*

## 2023

87. DELVE Collaboration Meeting
*How to also find what you are not looking for: going on a fishing expedition*

86. XIX J-PAS Collaboration Meeting
*An R-process Enhanced Extremely Metal-Poor Star Identified with Narrow-band Photometry*

**85**. International Research Network for Nuclear Astrophysics – Online Seminar Series (watch it on Youtube)
*Neutron-capture in the wild: finding r-process enhanced metal-poor stars in the Milky Way and beyond*

84. Observatório Nacional – S-PLUS 18th Collaboration Meeting
*An r-process enhanced extremely metal-poor star identified by S-PLUS*

**83**. NSF's NOIRLab – NOIRLab South Colloquium
*What else can you find when looking for Carbon Enhanced Ultra Metal-Poor Stars? A GHOST Story*

82. NSF's NOIRLab – GHOST Webinar Series
*How to Find What You Are Not Looking For: The curious case of SPLUS J1424-2542*

**81**. Lund University
*What else can you find when looking for Ultra Metal-Poor Stars?*

80. NSF's NOIRLab – SWEETS (Support Work Education and Exchange Talk Series)
*The US National Gemini Office*

## 2022

79. Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – 18th J-PAS Collaboration Meeting
*The miniJPAS survey: stellar atmospheric parameters from 56 optical filters*

78. NSF's NOIRLab – DECam at 10 years - Looking Back, Looking Forward
*Searching for Chemically Pristine Stars with Narrowband Photometry*

77. Centro Brasileiro de Pesquisas Físicas – S-PLUS 17th Collaboration Meeting
*Mining S-PLUS for Metal-Poor Stars in the Milky Way*

**76**. Planetário da Gávea, Rio de Janeiro – O Céu do Sul e suas Maravilhas
*SPLUS J2104−0049 e a Evolução Química do Universo*

**75**. Universidade de São Paulo – Astronomia ao Meio-dia (watch it on Youtube – in Portuguese)
*A Tabela Periódica Astrofísica*

**74**. Universidade de São Paulo – Astrophysics Colloquium (watch it on Youtube)
*Is Carbon Ubiquitous in the High-Redshift Universe? A Stellar Archaeology perspective*

73. Gemini Observatory Science Meeting 2022
*Making good use of bad weather: a chemically pristine star found through the clouds with Gemini*

**72**. Observatório Nacional – Seminário da Coordenação de Astronomia e Astrofísica
*Stellar Archaeology and Near-Field Cosmology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe*

## 2021

71. Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS 16th Collaboration Meeting
*Mining the S-PLUS catalog to find chemically peculiar stars in the Galaxy*

**70**. Instituto Nacional de Pesquisas Espaciais – Seminários da Divisão de Astrofísica (watch it on watch it on Youtube)
*Stellar Archaeology and Near-Field Cosmology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe*

**69**. Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina – IX Encontro de Física e Astronomia da UFSC
*Stellar Archaeology and Near-Field Cosmology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe*

**68**. Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program
*The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from Two Stars in the Milky Way*

*67. Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS 15th Collaboration Meeting*
*Searching for low-metallicity stars in S-PLUS*

***66**. NSF's NOIRLab – Live from NOIRLab @ Hawai'i (watch it on Youtube)*
*A chemically-peculiar star found from its colors*

## 2020

**65**. NSF's NOIRLab – Live from NOIRLab @ Hawai'i (Youtube)
*The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from Two Stars in the Milky Way*

**64**. NSF's NOIRLab – Gemini Observatory Science Coffee
*From R=40 to R=40,000: Mining narrow-band photometric catalogs in search of low-metallicity stars*

***63**. Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program*
*The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from Two Stars in the Milky Way*

***62**. Regional Center for Space Science and Tec Education for West Asia / Arab Union for Astronomy & Space Science*
*Our eyes in the skies: How telescopes help us place ourselves in the Universe*

***61**. NSF's NOIRLab Colloquium*
*Near-Field Cosmology with Narrow-Band Photometry and Spectroscopy of Low-Metallicity Stars*

***60**. Universidade de São Paulo – Astrophysics Colloquium*
*Near-Field Cosmology using Narrow-Band Photometry and Low-Metallicity Stars*

***59**. Universidade de São Paulo – Astronomia ao Meio-dia (watch it on Youtube – in Portuguese)*
*Agulhas no palheiro: A evolução química e idade do Universo contadas por duas estrelas*

## 2019

**58**. National Optical Astronomy Observatory
*Stellar Archaeology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe through Color Maps of the Night Sky*

***57**. Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program*
*The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from two stars in the Milky Way*

*56. Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas – 17th J-PAS Collaboration Meeting*
*Identification of Low-Metallicity Stars from Narrow-Band Photometry*

***55***. *San Francisco State University – Physics & Astronomy Colloquium*
*Stellar Archaeology: Origin of the Chemical Elements in the Universe through a 59-Color Map of the Sky*

## 2018

**54**. Kavli IPMU at The University of Tokyo – Stellar Archaeology as a Time Machine to the First Stars
*The Mass Distribution of the First Stars revealed by Abundance Pattern Matching of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars*

53. Kavli IPMU at The University of Tokyo – Introduction to Stellar Archaeology
*Radioactive Stellar Ages*

**52**. Texas A&M University Commerce – Physics & Astronomy Colloquium
*Stellar Archaeology: Understanding the Origin of the Chemical Elements through a 59-Color Map of the Night Sky*

**51**. Chungnam National University – Department of Astronomy & Space Science Seminar
*The Origin of the Chemical Elements in the Universe revealed by a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky*

**50**. Korea Astronomy and Space Science Institute Colloquium
*Constraints on Near-Field Cosmology through Abundance Pattern Matching of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars*

**49**. Universidade de São Paulo – Astronomy Colloquium
*The Southern Photometric Local Universe Survey (S-PLUS): An Overview*

48. Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS Meeting
*Short update on S-PLUS SHORTS*

47. University of Notre Dame – Astronomy 1-minute talks (23 presenters)
*Organizer and Presenter*

**46**. University of Notre Dame – Our Universe Revealed
*A day in the life of an Astronomer*

45. Kavli Institute for Cosmological Physics – Near-Field Cosmology with the Dark Energy Survey
*The Age Structure of the Milky Way Halo revealed by DES*

**44**. Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program
*Can we talk about the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe by looking at only two stars?*

43. Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – J-PLUS 2$^{\text{nd}}$ Virtual Meeting
*J-PLUS Stellar Parameter Value Added Catalog*

**42**. Shanghai Jiao Tong University – Tsung-Dao Lee Institute Workshop on The Exploding Universe
*Probing the mass distribution of the first stars through abundance pattern matching of ultra metal-poor stars*

**41**. JINA-CEE Frontiers in Nuclear Astrophysics – Main Conference
*Observational constraints on the origin of the elements: from First stars to Neutron-Star mergers*

**40**. Manhattan College – Physics Department Colloquium
*Understanding the Origin of the Elements in the Universe through a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky*

**39**. JINA-CEE Frontiers in Nuclear Astrophysics – Junior Workshop
*Speaking Skills*

**38**. Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – 16th J-PAS Collaboration Meeting - Pathfinder science
*Constraints on First-Star Nucleosynthesis from J-PAS Photometry of Low-Metallicity Stars*

37. Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS Collaboration Meeting (online)
*Updates on S-PLUS Short Survey(s)*

## 2017

36. Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS Collaboration Meeting (online)
*Updates on S-PLUS Short Survey(s)*

**35**. Michiana Astronomical Society – MAS monthly meeting speaker
*A Tale of Two Stars: Revealing the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe*

34. University of Notre Dame – Astro-Skills Lunch
*The do's and don'ts when plotting data*

33. Red de Infraestructuras de Astronomia – Early Data Release and Scientific Exploitation of the J-PLUS Survey
*Identification of (Bright) Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars with J-PLUS Photometry*

32. GMT Community Science Meeting – Chemical Evolution of the Universe
*A Monte Carlo approach to find the Progenitors of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars* (Rapid Poster Talk)

31. University of Notre Dame – The Great American Eclipse at Notre Dame
Co-organizer / Astronomy faculty representative – 3,500 attendees

**30**. University of Notre Dame – Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) Program
*A needle in a haystack: What one star can tell us about the age and chemical evolution of the entire Universe*

29. Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – J-PLUS 1$^{st}$ Virtual Meeting
*Identifying (Carbon-Enhanced) Metal-Poor Stars from J-PLUS Photometry*

**28**. Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program
*Stellar Archaeology: The Age and Chemistry of the Universe revealed by old Stars*

**27**. Universidade de São Paulo – Astrophysics Colloquium
*Searching for the Origin of the Elements Using a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky*

## 2016

**26**. University of Notre Dame – Astrophysics Seminar
*A Monte Carlo approach to find the Progenitors of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars*

**25**. University of Notre Dame – Department of Physics Colloquium
*Searching for the Origin of the Elements Using a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky*

24. University of Notre Dame – Astronomy 1-minute talks (19 presenters)
*Organizer and Presenter*

23. Universidade de São Paulo – X-PLUS Collaboration Meeting
*Identifying Bright Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars from S-PLUS Photometry*

**22**. University of Notre Dame – Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) Program
*Near-Field Cosmology with Metal-Poor Stars*

**21**. University of Notre Dame – Our Universe Revealed
*A day in the life of an Astronomer*

20. University of Notre Dame – Our Universe Revealed
*Our eyes in the skies: How telescopes help us place ourselves in the Universe*

19. 227th Meeting of the American Astronomical Society
*Identifying Bright Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars in the RAVE Catalog*

## 2015

18. University of Notre Dame – Our Universe Revealed
*The stuff we are made of: how do we determine the chemical elements in stars and the Universe?*

17. University of Notre Dame – Astronomy 1-minute talks (15 presenters)
*Organizer and Presenter*

**16**. Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics / University of Notre Dame – High School On Air Talk
*Stellar Archaeology: The Age and Chemistry of the Universe revealed by old Stars* – *YouTube video*

**15**. Michigan State University – JINA-CEE Nuclear Astrophysics Lunch Research Discussions
*Observing the First Stars through the Atmospheres of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars*

14. Universidade de São Paulo – X-PLUS Collaboration Meeting
*Identifying Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars from S-PLUS Photometry*

**13**. University of Notre Dame – Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) Program
*Galactic Archaeology: The Chemical Evolution and Age of the Universe revealed by old Stars*

## 2014

**12**. University of Notre Dame – Astronomy Seminar
*Exploring the history of the Galactic halo with Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor stars*

**11**. Massachusetts Institute of Technology – Kavli Institute
*Exploring the history of the Galactic halo with Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor stars*

## 2013

10. National Optical Astronomy Observatory
*(Carbon Enhanced) metal-poor stars and the chemical evolution of the Universe*

**9**. Gemini Observatory – Northern Operations Center
*Metal-poor stars as tracers of the chemical evolution of the Galaxy*

## 2012

**8**. Universidade Cruzeiro do Sul - Astronomy Colloquium
*Search for Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor stars in the Halo(es) of the Galaxy*

**7**. Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy Colloquium
*Spectroscopy from R=300 to 30000: metal-poor stars and Galactic chemical evolution*

**6**. Universidade de São Paulo - Invitation to Physics: undergraduate weekly seminar
*Arqueologia Galáctica: a evolução química do universo revelada por estrelas pobres em metais*

5. Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy at noon: undergraduate weekly seminar
*Census of the Milky Way*

## 2011

4. Universidade de São Paulo - Chemical Evolution Group Seminar
*Rediscovering the Dual Halo of the Milky Way via Hierarquical Clustering*

3. Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy at noon: undergraduate weekly seminar
*Stellar Archaeology*

2. Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy Colloquium
*Making good use of bad weather: finding extremely metal-poor stars in the clouds*

**1**. ESO Headquarters - Santiago - Astronomy Colloquium
*Searches for Metal-Poor Stars from the Hamburg/ESO Survey using the CH G-band*

# Academic Experience

## Student/Postdoc supervision

**Postdoctoral level**

2022–2023 Felipe de Almeida Fernandes (Universidade de São Paulo - Visiting Fellow at NSF NOIRLab)

**Graduate Level**

2025– Debasish Hazarika (University of Atacama, Chile - Visiting Student at NSF NOIRLab)
2023–2024 Eduardo Machado Pereira (Observatório Nacional, Brazil - Visiting Student at NSF NOIRLab)
2019–2022 Carlos Andrés Galarza Arevalo (Observatório Nacional - Brazil)
2019–2022 Joseph Zepeda (University of Notre Dame)
2019–2022 Derek Shank (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Sarah Dietz (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Dmitrii Gudin (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Devin Whitten (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Kaitlin Rasmussen (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2017 Geoffrey Lentner (University of Notre Dame)
2010–2016 Rafael Santucci (M.Sc. and Ph.D. - Universidade de São Paulo)

**Undergraduate Level - University of Notre Dame**

2020 Dante Komater (Physics Major)
2019–2020 Lucas Pinheiro (Engineering Major)
2019 Shenghua Liu (Physics Major)
2019 Winter Allen (Arkansas Tech University - REU)
2019 Yihao Zhou (Shanghai Jiao Tong University - REU)
2016–2018 Erik Peterson
2016–2018 David Kalamarides
2015–2018 Spencer Clark (Glynn Family Honors Program) - Senior Thesis
2016–2017 John Roach
2016–2017 Cristobal Gonzales
2016–2017 Michael Kurkowski
2017 Jazmine Jefferson (University of Kansas - REU)
2017 Derek Shank (Ohio Wesleyan University - DISC/REU) - video report
2017 Diego Fernandez (University of Oregon - REU)
2016 Travis Hodges (Austin Peay State University - DISC/REU)
2016 Miguel Correa (San Diego State University - REU)
2015 Siyu He (Xi'an Jiaotong University - REU)
2012–2014 William Alves (Universidade de São Paulo)
2008–2010 Rafael Santucci (Universidade de São Paulo)

## Committee Service - University of Notre Dame

2019–2020 Undergraduate Research, Department of Physics
2016–2018 Graduate Recruitment, Department of Physics
2015–2018 Preliminary Exam Committee, Department of Physics
2015–2018 University Committee on Research & Sponsored Programs, Notre Dame Research

## Thesis Defense Committee

2025 Eduardo Machado Pereira (Ph.D.)
Observatório Nacional
2024 Paulo Cesar Vargas Junior (M.Sc.)
Universidade Federal de Goiás
2024 Guilherme Limberg (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2024 Franklin T. S. Sampaio (M.Sc.)
Universidade Federal de Goiás
2024 Fábio Carneiro Wanderley (Ph.D.)
Observatório Nacional
2024 Elvis William Carvalho Cantelli (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2023 Yuri Abuchaim de Oliveira (M.Sc.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2023 Fabricia Oliveira Barbosa (M.Sc.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2018–2022 Heitor Ernandes (Ph.D. - committee chair)
Universidade de São Paulo
2021 Raphaela Fernandes de Melo (M.Sc.)
Observatório Nacional
2019 Henrique Reggiani (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2016 Rafael Miloni Santucci (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
2016 Camilo Francisco Javier Muñoz Peña (M.Sc.)
Universidade de São Paulo

## Organizing Committee - Conferences and Workshops

2024 Rare Gems in Big Data
NSF NOIRLab
2022 DECam at 10 years - Looking Back, Looking Forward
NSF NOIRLab

## Teaching

### Lead Instructor (LI) / Co-Instructor (CI) / Guest Lecturer (GL)

#### Undergraduate

**University of Notre Dame**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 2020 | (LI) | Descriptive Astronomy (SU20-PHYS-10140) |
| | | Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report |
| | (LI) | Descriptive Astronomy (SP20-PHYS-10140) |
| | | Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report |
| | (LI) | General Physics B - E & M Laboratory (SP20-PHYS-11422) |
| | | Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report |
| | (GL) | Engineering Physics II Laboratory (SP20-PHYS-11320) |
| | (GL) | Engineering Physics I Laboratory (SP20-PHYS-11310) |
| 2019 | (LI) | Physics A - Mechanics Laboratory (FA19-PHYS-11411) |
| | | Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report |
| | (LI) | Descriptive Astronomy (SU19-PHYS-10140) |
| | | Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report |
| 2018 | (GL) | Descriptive Astronomy (FA18-PHYS-10140) |
| 2017 | (CI) | Descriptive Astronomy (FA17-PHYS-10140) |
| | (LI) | General Physics B - E & M Laboratory (SP17-PHYS-11422) |
| | | Course Instructor Feedback: 4.8/5.0 - link to full report |
| 2016 | (GL) | Descriptive Astronomy (FA16-PHYS-10140) |
| 2015 | (GL) | Modern Observational Techniques (FA15-PHYS-30481) |

**Universidade Virtual do Estado de São Paulo**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 2012 | (LI) | Sky and Stars: An introduction |
| | (LI) | Galaxies: An introduction |
| 2011 | (LI) | Sky and Stars: An introduction |
| | (LI) | Galaxies: An introduction |

#### Graduate

**University of Notre Dame**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 2017 | (CI) | Astrophysics: Stars (SP17-PHYS-80202) |
| 2016 | (CI) | Large-Scale Astronomical Surveys (SP16-PHYS-70210) |
| 2015 | (GL) | Astrophysics: Stars (SP15-PHYS-80202) |

**Universidade de São Paulo**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 2012 | (GL) | Observational Astronomy |

### Teaching Assistant - Universidade de São Paulo

| | |
|---|---|
| 2009 | Introduction to Astronomy |
| | Fundamental Astronomy |
| 2008 | Introduction to Astronomy |
| 2007 | Fundamental Astronomy |

# Other relevant information

## Technical skills

Linux/Unix/MACOSX/Windows operating systems
Shell Scripting (sh, bash, tcsh, zsh)
LaTeX, OpenOffice, MS Office. Co-author of the LaTeXtemplate IAGTESE
Python (iPython/Jupyter Notebooks): scipy, numpy, pandas, scikitlearn, pyfits, astropy
R-project (terminal/RStudio): FITSio, tidyverse, cluster, sciviews
Databases: SQL (PostgreSQL/pgAdmin3), SDSS CasJobs, ADQL (J-PLUS/J-PAS/TAPVizieR)
Web: html, ccs, wordpress, apache, curl, wget, ssh, ftp, drupal, Google Analytics, Matomo
Graphics: Gnuplot, ggplot2, matplotlib, bokeh, tableau
Data reduction: IRAF/Pyraf packages, DRAGONS, ESO Reflex/Gasgano
Astronomy tools: WCSTools, CDSclient, STILTS, SkyCalc
Documentation: Sphinx, readthedocs
Version control and DevOps: Git, GitHub, GitLab

## Online Resources

| | |
|---|---|
| Webpage: | http://vmplacco.github.io/ |
| LinkedIn: | https://www.linkedin.com/in/vinicius-placco/ |
| GitHub: | https://github.com/vmplacco/ |
| stackoverflow: | https://stackoverflow.com/users/5964833/vinicius-placco |
| pythonanywhere: | https://vplacco.pythonanywhere.com/ |
| Sample webpages/ side projects: | http://vmplacco.github.io/#resources |

## Professional Affiliations/Service

Member of the American Astronomical Society
Member of the Brazilian Astronomical Society
Member of the Brazilian Physical Society
Member of the JINA Center for the Evolution of the Elements

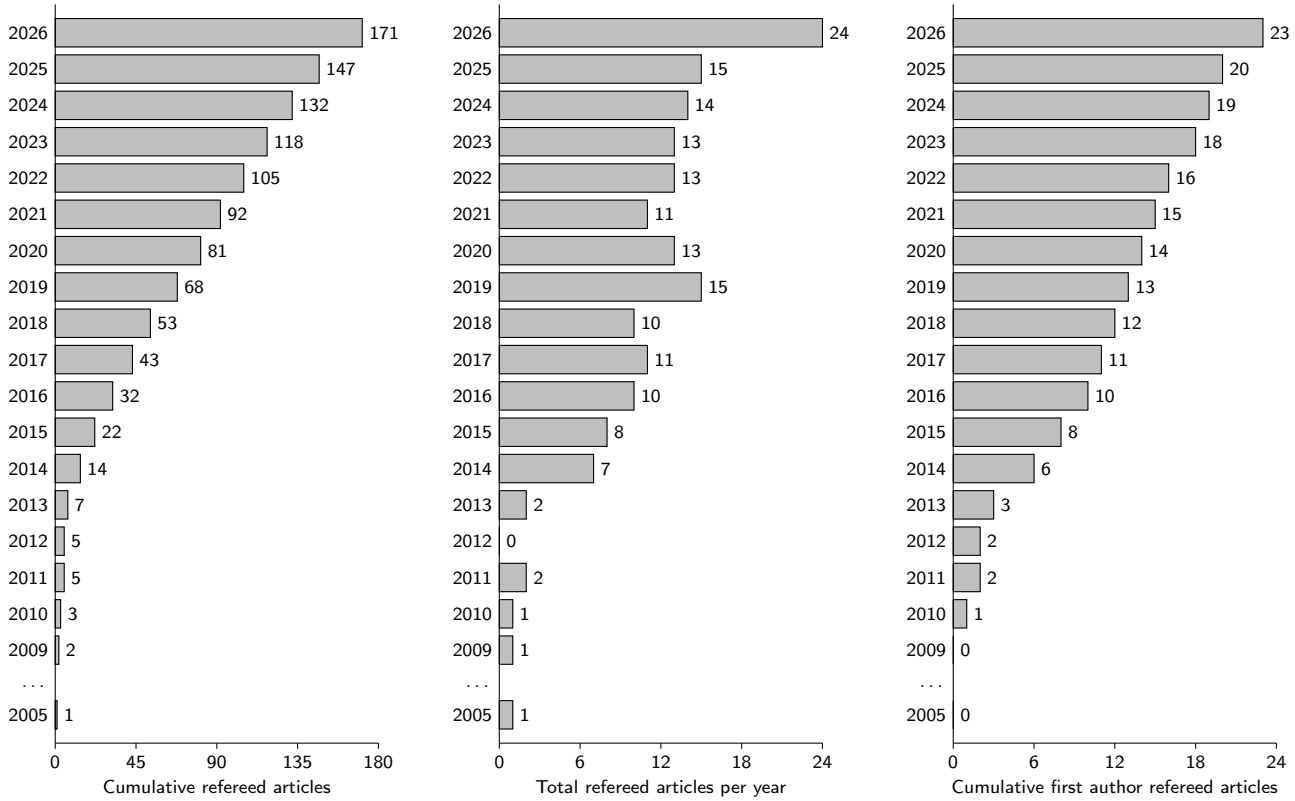
Referee for The Astronomy and Astrophisics Review
Referee for the American Astronomical Society Journals
Referee for the AAAS Science Magazine
Referee for Astronomy & Astrophysics
Referee for Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society
Referee for Astronomy & Computing

## Quantitative Indicators

- astrophysics data system (November 3, 2026 - ADS link)
  - **citations ( as first author)**
  - **h-index = 51 (19 as first author)**
  - **i10-index = 137 (20 as first author)**
- Google Scholar (November 3, 2026 - Google Scholar link)
  - **15643 citations**
  - **h-index = 57**
  - **i10-index = 137**
- ADS Publication Lists
  - Complete - ADS link
  - Refereed only - ADS link
- ORCID iD - 0000-0003-4479-1265

## Publication List - Refereed Articles

Total: 171 publications (including 23 first, 16 second, and 20 third author articles)



## First Author ($\star$ for relevant non-refereed publications)

23. **Placco, V. M.**, Rodrigues de Lima, E. V., Mendes de Oliveira, C. L., et al.
*S-PLUS in the 4MOST Era: From Metal-Poor Stars to Galaxy Clusters*
**2026**, **The Astronomical Journal**, submitted

22. **Placco, V. M.** & Vacca, W. D.
*Near-Infrared Observations of BD+44°493 with IGRINS-2*
**2026**, **The Astronomical Journal**, vol. 172, 142 (ADS)

21. **Placco, V. M.**, Limberg, G., Kennedy, C., Christlieb, N.
*HE 0144−4657: A Carbon-Enhanced Ultra Metal-Poor Star ([Fe/H]$\sim -4.1$) from the Helmi Stream Disrupted Dwarf Galaxy*
**2026**, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 1000, L34 (ADS)

20. **Placco, V. M.**, Limberg, G., Chiti, A., Prabhu, D. S., Ji, A. P., Barbosa, F. O., Cerny, W., Pace, A. B., Stringfellow, G. S., Sand, D. J., Martínez-Vázquez, C. E., Riley, A. H., Rossi, S., Noël, N. E. D., Vivas, A. K., Medina, G. E., Drlica-Wagner, A., Sakowska, J. D., Mutlu-Pakdil, B., Massana, P., Carballo-Bello, J. A., Choi, Y., Crnojević, D., Tan, C. Y.
*The DECam MAGIC Survey: Spectroscopic Follow-up of the Most Metal-Poor Stars in the Distant MW Halo*
**2025**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 991, 101 (ADS)

19. **Placco, V. M.**, Gupta, A. F., Almeida-Fernandes, F., Logsdon, S. E., Rajagopal, J., Holmbeck, E. M., Roederer, I. U., Della Costa, J., Fernandez, P., Golub, E., Higuera, J., Patel, Y., Ridgway, S., Schweiker, H.
*BD+44°493: Chemo-Dynamical Analysis and Constraints on Companion Planetary Masses from WIYN/NEID Spectroscopy*
**2024**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 977, 12 (ADS)

$\star$ **Placco, V. M.**, Herrera, D., Merino, B. M., Hirst, P., Labrie, K., Simpson, C., Turner, J., Vacca, W. D., Deibert, E., Diaz, R., Heo, J., Kalari, V., Reggiani, H., Rodriguez, C., Ruiz-Carmona, R., Thomas-Osip, J.
*GHOST Reduced Data Products for the Gemini Observatory Community and Beyond*
**2024**, **Research Notes of the American Astronomical Society**, vol. 8, 12 (ADS)

18. **Placco, V. M.**, Almeida-Fernandes, F., Holmbeck, E. M., Roederer, I. U., Mardini, M. K., Hayes, C. R., Venn, K., Chiboucas, K., Deibert, E., Gamen, R., Heo, J., Jeong, M., Kalari, V., Martioli, E., Xu, S., Diaz, R., Gomez-Jimenez, M., Henderson, D., Prado, P., Quiroz, C., Ruiz-Carmona, R., Simpson, C., Urrutia, C., McConnachie, A. W., Pazder, J., Burley, G., Ireland, M., Waller, F., Berg, T. A. M., Robertson, J. G., Hartman, Z., Jones, D. O., Labrie, K., Perez, G., Ridgway, S., Thomas-Osip, J.
*SPLUS J142445.34−254247.1: An R-Process Enhanced, Actinide-Boost, Extremely Metal-Poor star observed with GHOST*
**2023**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 959, 60 (ADS)

17. **Placco, V. M.** & Stanghellini, L.
*US National Gemini Office in the NOIRLab era*
**2023**, **Journal of Astronomical Telescopes, Instruments, and Systems**, vol. 9, 7003 (ADS)

16. **Placco, V. M.**, Almeida-Fernandes, F., Arentsen, A., Lee, Y. S., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A.
*Mining S-PLUS for Metal-Poor Stars in the Milky Way*
**2022**, **The Astrophysical Journal Supplement Series**, vol. 262, 8 (ADS)

15. **Placco, V. M.**, Roederer, I. U., Lee, Y. S., Almeida-Fernandes, F., Herpich, F. R., Perottoni, H. D., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A.
*SPLUS J210428.01−004934.2: An Ultra Metal-Poor Star Identified from Narrow-Band Photometry*
**2021**, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 912, 32 (ADS)

$\star$ **Placco, V. M.**, Sneden, C., Roederer, I. U., Lawler, J. E., Den Hartog, E. A., Hejazi, N., Maas, Z., Bernath, P.
*linemake: an Atomic and Molecular Line List Generator*
**2021**, **Research Notes of the American Astronomical Society**, vol. 5, 92 (ADS | PDF)

14. **Placco, V. M.**, Santucci, R. M., Yuan, Z., Mardini, M. K., Holmbeck, E. M., Wang, X., Surman, R., Hansen, T., Roederer, I. U., Beers, T., Choplin, A., Ji, A., Ezzeddine, R., Frebel, A., Sakari, C., Whitten, D., Zepeda, J.
*The R-Process Alliance: The Peculiar Chemical Abundance Pattern of RAVE J183013.5−455510*
**2020**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 897, 78 (ADS)

13. **Placco, V. M.**, Santucci, R. M., Beers, T. C., Chanamé, J., Sepúlveda, M. P., Coronado, J., Rossi, S., Lee, Y. S., Starkenburg, E., Youakim, K., Barrientos, M., Ezzeddine, R., Frebel, A., Hansen, T. T., Holmbeck, E. M., Ji, A. P., Rasmussen, K. C., Roederer, I. U., Sakari, C. M., Whitten, D. D.
*The R-Process Alliance: Spectroscopic Follow-up of 857 Low-Metallicity Star Candidates from the Best & Brightest Survey*
**2019**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 870, 122 (ADS)

12. **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Santucci, R. M., Chanamé, J., Sepúlveda, M. P., Coronado, J., Points, S. D., Kaleida, C. C., Rossi, S., Kordopatis, G., Lee, Y. S., Matijevič, G., Frebel, A., Hansen, T. T., Holmbeck, E. M., Rasmussen, K. C., Roederer, I. U., Sakari, C. M., Whitten, D. D.
*Spectroscopic Validation of Low-Metallicity Stars from RAVE*
**2018**, **The Astronomical Journal**, vol. 155, 256 (ADS)

11. **Placco, V. M.**, Holmbeck, E. M., Frebel, A., Beers, T. C., Surman, R. A., Ji, A. P., Ezzedine, R., Points, S. D., Kaleida, C. C., Hansen, T. T., Sakari, C. M., Casey, A. R.
*RAVE J203843.2−002333: The First Highly R-process-enhanced Star Identified in the RAVE Survey.*
**2017**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 844, 18 (ADS)

10. **Placco, V. M.**, Frebel, A., Beers, T. C., Yoon, J., Chiti, A., Heger, A. Chan, C., Casey, A. R., Christlieb, N.
*Observational Constraints on First-Star Nucleosynthesis. II. Spectroscopy of an Ultra Metal-Poor CEMP-no Star*
**2016**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 833, 21 (ADS)

9. **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Reggiani, H., Meléndez, J.
*G64−12 and G64−37 are Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars*
**2016**, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 829, 24 (ADS)

8. **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Ivans, I. I., Filler, D., Imig, J. A., Roederer, I., Abate, C., Hansen, T., Cowan, J., Frebel, A., Lawler, J. E., Schatz, H., Sneden, C., Sobeck, J., Aoki, W., Smith, V. V., Bolte, M.
*Hubble Space Telescope Near-Ultraviolet Spectroscopy of the Bright CEMP-s Stars*
**2015**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 812, 109 (ADS)

7. **Placco, V. M.**, Frebel, A., Lee, Y. S., Jacobson, H. R., Beers, T. C., Pena, J. M., Chan, C., Heger, A.
*Metal-poor Stars Observed with the Magellan Telescope. III. New Extremely and Ultra Metal-Poor Stars from SDSS/SEGUE and Insights on the Formation of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars*
**2015**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 809, 136 (ADS)

6. **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Frebel, A., Stancliffe R.
*Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Star Frequencies in the Galaxy: Corrections for the Effect of Evolutionary Status on Carbon Abundances*
**2014**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 797, 21 (ADS)

5. **Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Roederer, I., Cowan, J., Frebel, A., Filler, D., Ivans, I. I., Lawler, J. E., Schatz, H., Sneden, C., Sobeck, J., Aoki, W., Smith, V. V.
*Hubble Space Telescope Near-Ultraviolet Spectroscopy of the Bright CEMP-no Star BD+44°493*
**2014**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 790, 34 (ADS)

4. **Placco, V. M.**, Frebel, A., Beers, T. C., Christlieb, N., Lee, Y. S., Kennedy, C. R., Rossi, S., Santucci, R.
*Metal-poor Stars Observed with the Magellan Telescope. II. Discovery of Four Stars with [Fe/H]$\leq -3.5$*
**2014**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 781, 40 (ADS)

3. **Placco, V. M.**, Frebel A., Beers T. C., Karakas A., Kennedy C. R., Rossi S., Christlieb N., Stancliffe R.
*Metal-Poor Stars Observed with the Magellan Telescope I. Constraints on Progenitor Mass and Metallicity of*

*AGB Stars Undergoing s-Process Nucleosynthesis*
**2013**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 770, 104 (ADS)

2. **Placco, V. M.**, Kennedy C.R., Beers T.C., Christlieb N., Rossi S., Sivarani T., Lee Y.S., Reimers D., Wisotzki L.
*Searches for Metal-Poor Stars from the Hamburg/ESO Survey using the CH G-band*
**2011**, **The Astronomical Journal**, vol. 142, 188 (ADS)

1. **Placco, V. M.**, Kennedy C.R., Rossi S., Beers T.C., Lee Y.S., Christlieb N., Sivarani T., Reimers D., Wisotzki L.
*A Search for Unrecognized Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars in the Galaxy*
**2010**, **The Astronomical Journal**, vol. 139, 1051 (ADS)

## Second/Third Author ($\star$ for relevant non-refereed publications)

36. Jeong, M., Lee, Y. S., **Placco, V. M.**, Hirai, Y., Beers, T., Heo, J., Chiboucas, K., Deibert, E., Gamen, R., Kalari, V., Martioli, E., Diaz, R., Gomez-Jimenez, M., Ruiz-Carmona, R., Burley, G., Robertson, J. G., Labrie, K., Thomas-Osip, J.
*The Actinide-Boost Star LAMOST J122216.85−063345.2: A Detailed $R$-process Abundance Study with Gemini-S/GHOST*
**2026**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 1005, 92 (ADS)

35. Mardini, M. K., Frebel, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Chiti, A., MAnolia, Y., Beers, T., Ezzeddine, R., Hansen, T. T., Holmbeck, E. M., Roederer, I. U., Sakari, C. M.
*The R-process Alliance: A Bright, Strongly R-process-enhanced Extremely Metal-poor Star Observed with GHOST*
**2026**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 1005, 20 (ADS)

34. Chiti, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Pace, A., Ji, A., Prabhu, D., Cerny, W., Limberg, G., Stringfellow, G., Drlica-Wagner, A., Atzberger, K., Choi, Y., Crnojević, D., Ferguson, P., Kallivayalil, N., Noël, N., Riley, A., Sand, D., Simon, J., Walker, A., Bom, C., Carballo-Bello, J., James, D., Martínez-Vázquez, C., Medina, G., Vivas, K.
*A second-generation star in a relic dwarf galaxy*
**2026**, **Nature Astronomy**, vol. 10, 830 (ADS)

33. Zhang, Z., Ji, A. P., **Placco, V. M.**, Curtis, S.
*Quantifying Element Importance for Mass Recovery from Population III Supernova Yield Fits*
**2026**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 1004, 252 (ADS)

32. Machado-Pereira, E., Daflon, S., **Placco, V. M.**, Cruz, P., Borges Fernandes, M., Jiménez-Esteban, F., Caballero, J. A., Anguiano, B., Yuan, H., Bonatto, C., Alvarez-Candal, A., Cenarro, J., Cristóbal-Hornillos, D., Hernández-Monteagudo, C., López-Sanjuan, C., Marín-Franch, A., Moles, M., Varela, J., Vázquez Ramió, H., Alcaniz, J., Dupke, R., Ederoclite, A., Sodré Jr., L., Angulo, R.
*J-PLUS: stellar parameter determination of members of open clusters using machine learning*
**2026**, **Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society**, vol. 546, 132 (ADS)

31. Roederer, I. U., **Placco, V. M.**, Karakas, A. I., Den Hartog, E. A., Beers, T. C.
*Abundances of Rarely Detected s-process Elements Derived from the Ultraviolet Spectrum of the s-process-enhanced Metal-poor Star HD 196944*
**2025**, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 995, 2 (ADS)

30. Limberg, G., **Placco, V. M.**, Ji, A. P., Yao, Y., Chiti, A., Mardini, M. K., Frebel, A., Rossi, S.
*Discovery of an [Fe/H]$\sim -4.8$ Star in Gaia XP Spectra*
**2025**, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 989, 18 (ADS)

29. Bandyopadhyay, A., Ezzeddine, R., **Placco, V. M.**, Frebel, A., Aguado, D. S., Roederer, I. U.
*Probing Abundance Variations Among Multiple Stellar Populations in the Metal-poor Globular Cluster NGC 2298 Using Gemini-South/GHOST*
**2025**, **The Astronomical Journal**, vol. 170, 37 (ADS)

⋆ Fitzpatrick, M., **Placco, V. M.**, Bolton, A., Merino, B., Ridgway, S., Stanghellini, L.
*Modernizing IRAF to Support Gemini Data Reduction*
2025, **Astronomical Data Analysis Software & Systems XXXIII** (ADS)

28. Perottoni, H. D., **Placco, V. M.**, Almeida-Fernandes, F., Herpich, F. R., Rossi, S., Beers, T., Smiljanic, R., Amarante, J., Limberg, G., Werle, A., Rocha-Pinto, H., Beraldo e Silva, L., Daflon, S., Alvarez-Candal, A., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A.
*The S-PLUS Ultra-Short Survey: First Data Release*
2024, **Astronomy & Astrophysics**, vol. 691, 138 (ADS)

27. Quispe-Huaynasi, F., Roig, F., **Placco, V. M.**, Beraldo e Silva, L., Pereira, C. B., Daflon, S., Kanaan, A., Mendes de Oliveira, C., Ribeiro, T., Schoenell, W.
*Characterisation of high velocity stars in the S-PLUS internal fourth data release*
2024, **Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society**, vol. 527, 6173 (ADS)

26. Almeida-Fernandes, F., **Placco, V. M.**, Rocha-Pinto, H. J., Borges Fernandes, M., Limberg, G., Beraldo e Silva, L., Amarante, J., Perottoni, H. D., Overzier, R., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A., Mendes de Oliveira, C.
*Chemodynamical Properties and Ages of Metal-Poor Stars in S-PLUS*
2023, **Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society**, vol. 523, 2934 (ADS)

25. Roederer, I. U., Pace, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Caldwell, N., Koposov, S., Mateo, M., Olszewski, E., Walker, M.
*Abundance Analysis of Stars at Large Radius in the Sextans Dwarf Spheroidal Galaxy*
2023, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 954, 55 (ADS)

24. Zepeda, J., Beers, T. C., **Placco, V. M.**, Shank, D., Gudin, D., Hirai, Y., Yoon, J., Mardini, M., Pifer, C., Catapano, T., Calagna, S.
*Chemo-Dynamically Tagged Groups of CEMP Stars in the Halo of the Milky Way. I. Untangling the Origins of CEMP-s and CEMP-no Stars*
2023, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 947, 23 (ADS)

23. Shank, D., Beers, T., **Placco, V. M.**, Gudin, D., Catapano, T., Holmbeck, E. M., Ezzeddine, R., Roederer, I. U., Sakari, C. M., Frebel, A. Hansen, T. T.
*The* R*-Process Alliance: Chemo-Dynamically Tagged Groups II. Extended Sample of Halo $r$-Process-Enhanced Stars*
2023, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 943, 23 (ADS)

22. Arentsen, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Lee, Y. S., Aguado, D. S., Martin, N. F., Starkenburg, E., Yoon, J.
*On the inconsistency of [C/Fe] abundances and the fractions of carbon-enhanced metal-poor stars among various stellar surveys*
2022, **Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society**, vol. 515, 4082 (ADS)

21. Shank, D., Beers, T., **Placco, V. M.**, Limberg, G., Jaques, E., Yuan, Zhen, Schlaufman, K. C., Casey, A. R., Huang, Y., Lee, Y. S., Hattori, K., Santucci, R. M.
*Dynamically Tagged Groups of Metal-Poor Stars from the Best & Brightest Survey*
2022, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 926, 26 (ADS)

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